



Bazaar

The ripper, the space searcher, the WebRazor, the chain mail armour and some other outstanding performers...



DELL Precision 530

Outstanding performer



This souped up machine highlights the differences between a ‘powerful PC’ and a graphics workstation. It has a dual 1.7 GHz Xeon P4 processors, 2 GB RDRAM, four 18-GB 15,000-rpm SCSI hard drives configured in RAID-0 configuration and a high resolution 17-inch TFT monitor whose display area is comparable to a 19-inch CRT monitor. The custom motherboard is based on the Intel 860 chipset and came with two IEEE 1394 (FireWire) ports and the optional Sound-Blaster Live! Value PCI card and a Broadcom Copper Giga-bit Ethernet Adapter.

All this luscious hardware fits into a neatly designed black plastic/alu-

minium casing, which uses a ‘no-screwdriver-needed’ design. Well placed fans provide excellent cooling while CPU noise levels are kept pretty low despite high airflows within the cabinet.

However, the price of this top-of-the-line workstation might burn a hole in your pocket. The workstation is great for designers working on 3D authoring tools and movie animations.

SPECIFICATIONS:
Dual Pentium 4 1.7 GHz Xeon processor, 2 GB ECC PC800 RDRAM, four 18-GB Ultra160 SCSI hard disks, Intel 860 chipset-based motherboard, Wildcat 5110 graphics sub-system, 17-inch TFT monitor

DELL Precision 530	
Performance	★★★★½
Build Quality	★★★★½
Value for Money	★★★★
Features	★★★★½
OVERALL	★★★★

Price: Rs 6,83,698 + taxes
Contact: DELL India
Phone: 080-5586110
Web site: www.dell.co.in

Samsung Samtron 56V

Fit for display

The Samsung Samtron 56V gave acceptable results in the screen regularity test but the red hue appeared slightly more intense in the middle of the screen. In the geometry test, the horizontal and vertical lines were found to be slightly askew, but within an acceptable range. In the screen regulation test, the raster expanded by just about 1 mm horizontally and vertically when the screen turned bright. In the symmetrical regulation tests



there was a slight white and black level shift near the edge of the white and black bands, which made the edge of the block appear blurry. This could result in a fuzzy image, especially when running the monitor at a resolution of 1024x768.

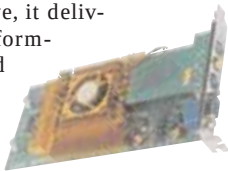
SPECIFICATIONS:
Maximum resolution: 1024 x 768 at 60 Hz, viewable area 13.9-inch

Samsung Samtron 56V	B+
Performance	★★★★½
Build Quality	★★★★½
Value for Money	★★★★½
Features	★★★★
OVERALL	★★★★½

MSI Starforce GeForce3 MS-8822

Gaming performance to die for

Though expensive, it delivers amazing performance and has a good overall bundle. However, you need a powerful system to realise the full potential of this card. In 3DMark 2001 the card scored an index of 6975, putting it on par with other GeForce3-based graphics cards. In *Quake III Arena*, it delivered an amazing 268 fps in high quality mode on our test



machine (1.7 GHz P4, 512 MB RDRAM). The card exhibited breathtaking Full Screen Anti Aliasing and per-pixel lighting effects.

SPECIFICATIONS:
GeForce3 64 MB DDR, 200 MHz core speed, 460 MHz memory speed,

MSI Starforce GeForce3		B+
Performance	★★★★	
Build Quality	★★★★	
Value for Money	★★★★	
Features	★★★★	
OVERALL	★★★★½	

Price: Rs 22,000
Contact: Priya Limited
Phone: 022-2663611
E-mail: priyabom@priyagroup.com
Web site: www.priyagroup.com